

AMENDED PACKAGE INSERT

SUNIZINE TABLET 10MG

Each tablet contains :
Cetirizine HCl 10mg

Product Description:
Round, white, convex, film-coated tablet with single score on one side only.

Pharmacodynamics:
In experimental animals, cetirizine has been shown to be an anti-H₁ agent devoid of any significant anticholinergic or antiserotonin effects. At pharmacological active doses, it induces neither sedation nor behavioural changes. This may be explained by the fact that cetirizine does not cross the blood-brain barrier. It was shown in human pharmacology studies that cetirizine will inhibit certain effects produced by exogenous histamine. This activity appears rapidly. Cetirizine also inhibits the effects produced by endogenous histamine released in vivo by an agent e.g. 48/80. Finally, it inhibits the cutaneous reaction induced by VIP (Vasoactive Intestinal Polypeptide) and substance P; neuropeptides which are believed to take part in the allergic reaction. Cetirizine markedly reduces bronchial hyper-reactivity to histamine in the asthmatic patient. It also reduces the allergic reaction induced by specific allergens. These effects are obtained without any effects being demonstrated either by psychometric test or by a quantified EEG.

Pharmacokinetics:
Peak blood levels of the order of 0.3 mg/ml are reached between 30 and 60 minutes after administration of a 10 mg dose of cetirizine. Its plasma half-life is approximately 11 hours. Absorption is very consistent from one subject to the next. Its renal clearance is 30 ml/minute and the excretion half-life is approximately 9 hours. Cetirizine is strongly bound to plasma proteins.

Indication:
Adults and children of 2 years and above: symptomatic treatment of seasonal allergic rhinitis, perennial allergic rhinitis and urticaria of allergic origin.

Recommended Dosage:
Adults
10 mg (1 tablet) once daily.
A 5 mg starting dose (half of the tablet) may be proposed if this leads to satisfactory control of the symptoms.

Children
Children aged from 2 to 6 years : 2.5 mg twice daily.
Children aged from 6 to 12 years : 5 mg (half of the tablet) twice daily.
Children over 12 years of age : 10 mg (1 tablet) once daily.

Elderly
Data do not suggest that the dose needs to be reduced in elderly subjects provided that the renal function is normal.

Patients with Moderate to Severe Renal Impairment
Since cetirizine is mainly excreted via renal route, in cases no alternative treatment can be used, the dosing intervals must be individualised according to renal function.

Dosing adjustments for adult patients with impaired renal function:

Group	Creatinine Clearance (ml/min)	Dosage and Frequency
Normal	> 80	10 mg once daily
Mild	50 - 79	10 mg once daily
Moderate	30 - 49	5 mg once daily
Severe	<30	5 mg once every 2 days
End-stage renal disease - Patients undergoing dialysis	<10	Contra-indicated

In paediatric patients suffering from renal impairment, the dose will have to be adjusted on an individual basis taking into account the renal clearance, age and body weight of the patient.

Patients with Hepatic Impairment
No dose adjustment is needed in patients with solely hepatic impairment.

Route of Administration: Oral.

Contraindications:
Cetirizine is contraindicated in:
• Patients with a history of hypersensitivity to any constituents of the product.
• Patients with severe renal impairment at less than 10 ml/min creatinine clearance.

Warnings and Precautions:
At therapeutic doses, cetirizine does not potentiate the effect of alcohol (at blood level of 0.8 g/L). Care should, however, be taken.

Activities Requiring Mental Alertness: In clinical trials the occurrence of somnolence has been reported in some patients taking cetirizine. Due caution should therefore be exercised when driving a car or operating potentially dangerous machinery. Patient should be advised, however, to take care not to exceed the recommended dose.

Interactions with Other Medicaments:
To date, there are no known interactions with other drugs. Nevertheless, cetirizine should be used with caution if sedatives are also being taken.

Alcohol and Other CNS Depressants
In sensitive patients, the concurrent use of alcohol or other CNS depressants may cause additional reductions in alertness and impairment of performance, although cetirizine does not potentiate the effect of alcohol.

Pregnancy and Lactation:
Caution should be exercised when prescribing to pregnant women. For cetirizine prospectively collected data on pregnancy outcomes do not suggest potential for maternal or foetal/embryonic toxicity above background rates.
Animal studies do not indicate direct or indirect harmful effects with respect to pregnancy, embryonal/foetal development, parturition or postnatal development.

Caution should be exercised when prescribing cetirizine to lactating women. Cetirizine is excreted in human milk at concentrations representing 25% to 90% of those measured in plasma, depending on sampling time after administration.

Side Effects:
There have been occasional reports of mild and transient subjective side effects such as headache, dizziness, drowsiness, agitation, dry mouth and gastrointestinal discomfort. In objective tests of psychomotor function, the incidence of sedation with cetirizine was similar to that of placebo. Occasionally, symptoms of hypersensitivity have been reported.

Symptoms and Treatment of Overdose:
Drowsiness can be a symptom of overdose, occurring from administration of 50mg of cetirizine as a single dose. To date, there is no specific antidote. In the case of massive overdose, gastric lavage should be performed as soon as possible. Usual supportive measures should be provided and routine observation carried out regularly.

Effects on Ability to Drive and Use Machine:
Objective measurements of driving ability, sleep latency and assembly line performance have not demonstrated any clinically relevant effects at the recommended dose of 10 mg.
However, patients who experience somnolence should refrain from driving, engaging in potentially hazardous activities or operating machinery.
Patients intending to drive, engaging in potentially hazardous activities or operating machinery should not exceed the recommended dose and should take their response to the medicinal product into account.

Storage Conditions: Store at or below 30°C. Protect from light.

Shelf-life: 3 years.

Pack sizes: Blister pack : 10 x 10, 50 x 10 and 100 x 10 tablets per strip.
Pack sizes (export only): Bottle pack: 100 and 500 tablets.

FURTHER INFORMATION CONCERNING THIS DRUG CAN BE OBTAINED FROM YOUR FAMILY PHYSICIAN / LOCAL GENERAL PRACTITIONER / PHARMACIST.

Manufacturer & Product Registration Holder:
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TL683A-R4
Revision Date: 20/10/2022